

Network Scanner Scripts

Pulling, running, and configuring `network_scanner.py` and `mobile_network_scanner.py`

Repository: <https://github.com/thomasmd321/local-network-toolkit>

Branch: main

Both scripts discover devices on your local network with no external service and no account required. **network_scanner.py** targets a normal desktop/Termux environment and can read ARP/MAC data directly; **mobile_network_scanner.py** targets a sandboxed environment such as an iPhone running a-Shell, where the OS blocks raw sockets and subprocess calls, so it relies on plain TCP connections instead.

	network_scanner.py	mobile_network_scanner.py
Target platform	Linux / macOS / Windows / Termux	iOS sandboxes (a-Shell, Pythonista)
Discovery method	ARP scan (scapy), ping-sweep fallback	Plain TCP connect probe
MAC address / vendor	Yes (IEEE OUI lookup)	No (not exposed to the sandbox)
IPv6 discovery	Yes (--ipv6)	No
Banner grabbing	--identify IP deep dive	Built into every scan
Risky-port flagging	Yes	Yes
NEW / CHG / missing tracking	Yes	Yes
IP-conflict / spoofing alert	Yes	No (no MAC available)
Retry a flaky scan	--retries N	--retries N
Export results	--output FILE (CSV/JSON)	--output FILE (CSV/JSON)
Scan history log	--log-history FILE	--log-history FILE
Excluding hosts	--exclude IP/CIDR	--exclude IP/CIDR

Custom device labels	--set-label / --remove-label	--set-label / --remove-label
Environment diagnostics	--doctor	--doctor
Quiet mode (cron/systemd)	--quiet	--quiet
Webhook notifications	--notify-webhook	--notify-webhook
Diff-only watch mode	--diff-only	--diff-only
Config file / profiles	--profile / --profile-file	--profile / --profile-file
Prometheus metrics export	--metrics-file	--metrics-file
Known-devices registry backup	--export/--import-known-devices	--export/--import-known-devices
MQTT / Home Assistant presence	--mqtt-host (+TLS, availability)	--mqtt-host (+TLS, availability)
Multi-subnet scanning	--all-subnets (parallel)	Manual comma-separated list
Shell tab-completion	completions.bash	completions.bash

1. Getting the scripts

Both scripts are plain, dependency-light Python files living in one repository. Pick whichever pull method fits where you're running them.

Clone the whole repository (desktop / Termux)

```
git clone https://github.com/thomasmd321/local-network-toolkit.git
cd local-network-toolkit
```

Grab a single file directly (no git needed)

Useful on iOS, or anywhere you only want one script without the rest of the repo:

```
BASE=https://raw.githubusercontent.com/thomasmd321/local-network-toolkit/main
curl -O $BASE/network_scanner.py
curl -O $BASE/mobile_network_scanner.py
```

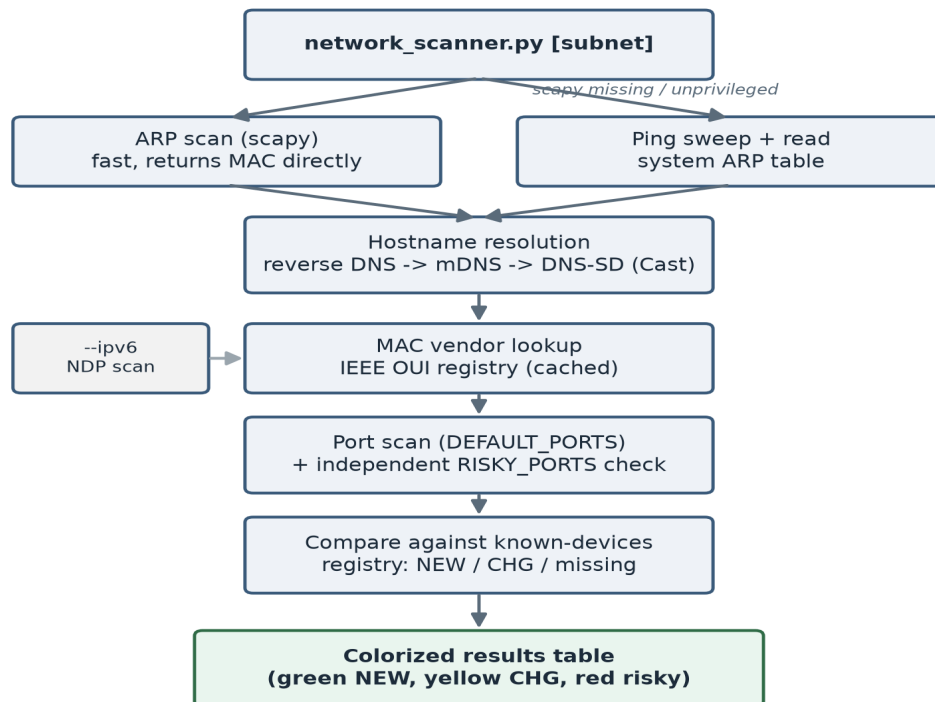
`curl -O` saves the file under its own name in the current directory and overwrites an existing copy, so re-running the same command later pulls in any updates.

On an iPhone

Install **a-Shell** from the App Store (not “a-Shell mini,” which strips out `git`), then run either the clone or the single-file `curl` command above from its terminal.

2. network_scanner.py

For a normal desktop, laptop, or Termux-on-Android environment. Prefers a fast ARP scan via scapy (returns MAC addresses directly); if scapy isn't installed or the process lacks the privileges ARP scanning needs, it falls back automatically to a multithreaded ping sweep plus the system's own ARP table — no flag needed to trigger this, it just happens.



Falls back automatically when scapy / raw sockets aren't available.

How a scan flows through network_scanner.py, start to finish.

Running it

```
python3 network_scanner.py                # auto-detect subnet
python3 network_scanner.py 192.168.1.0/24  # scan a specific subnet
python3 network_scanner.py --all-subnets   # every subnet (needs psutil)
python3 network_scanner.py --identify 192.168.1.42 # deep-dive one host
python3 network_scanner.py --watch 300      # rescan every 5 minutes
python3 network_scanner.py --output scan.json # save results to a file
```

Options

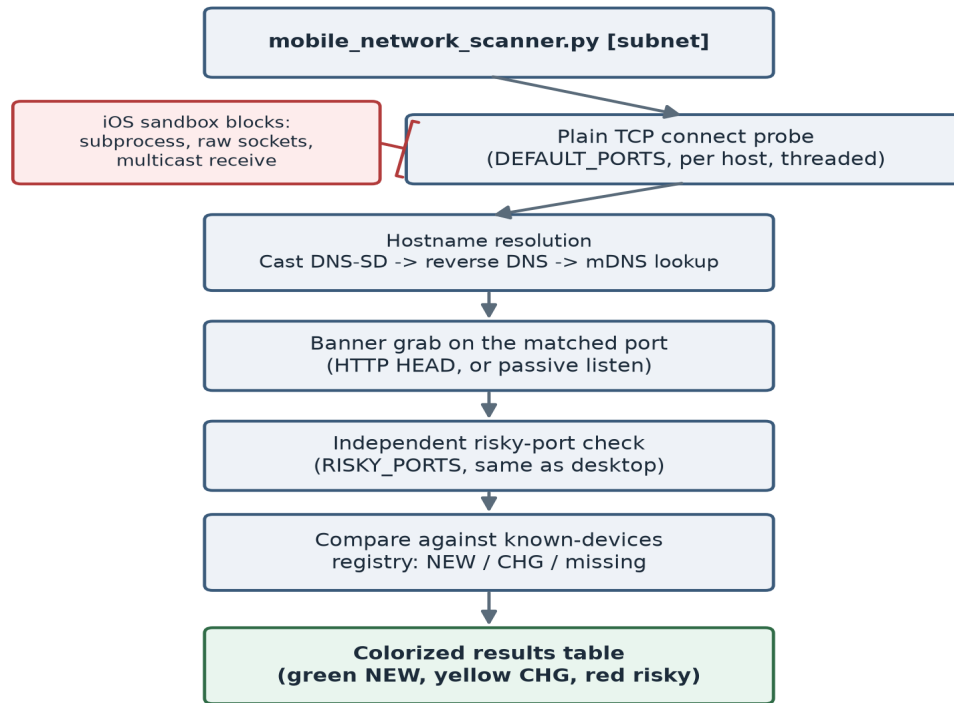
Flag	What it does
subnet	Positional. CIDR range(s) to scan, comma-separated for more than one. Auto-detected if omitted.
--all-subnets	Scan every local subnet this machine has an interface on (requires <code>pip install psutil</code>) instead of just the default route. Subnets are scanned concurrently, not one at a time, so several VLANs don't multiply the wall-clock cost.

Flag	What it does
--identify IP	Skip the network scan; do a slow, thorough single-host investigation instead (more ports, banner grabs, full hostname/vendor resolution).
--doctor	Skip the network scan; check this environment for everything this script can use (scapy, ping/arp, cache writability, mDNS, etc.) and report it.
--timeout SECONDS	Timeout per host (default: 1.0).
--retries N	Extra ARP/ping-sweep passes beyond the first, to recover a device that missed one reply due to transient packet loss (default: 0).
--mdns-timeout SECONDS	Timeout for the mDNS/DNS-SD hostname fallback (default: 0.3).
--no-vendor-lookup	Skip the IEEE OUI vendor lookup (avoids the first-run registry download).
--refresh-vendor-db	Force a fresh OUI registry download instead of using the cached copy.
--watch SECONDS	Rescan on a timer instead of once, printing NEW markers as they appear (Ctrl+C to stop).
--no-track-devices	Don't use the known-devices registry at all — no NEW/CHG markers, nothing remembered.
--forget-known-devices	Clear the registry first, so everything in this run shows as NEW.
--set-label KEY=LABEL	Assign a friendly label to a device (KEY is its MAC, or IP if it has none), shown instead of/alongside its hostname. Repeatable.
--remove-label KEY	Remove a device's custom label. Repeatable.
--ipv6	Also discover IPv6 devices via multicast ping + NDP (Linux/macOS only).
--ipv6-timeout SECONDS	Roughly how long to spend on IPv6 discovery (default: 2.0).
--no-scan-ports	Skip the open-port probe (and the risky-ports check that depends on it).
--ports LIST	Comma-separated TCP ports to probe instead of the built-in default list.
--exclude LIST	Comma-separated IPs and/or CIDR ranges to drop from the scan right after discovery (a bare IP is treated as a /32).
--port-timeout SECONDS	Per-port connection timeout, for both the port probe and risky-ports check (default: 0.3).
--no-risky-ports	Skip the risky-ports security check while keeping the general port probe.
--no-color	Disable ANSI color output (also respects the NO_COLOR env var).
--output FILE	Save this scan's results to FILE as JSON, or CSV if it ends in .csv.
--log-history FILE	Append this scan's results as one JSON line to FILE, instead of overwriting it like --output does.
--history-max-entries N	Cap FILE from --log-history at N lines, dropping the oldest first (default: 200).
--quiet	Print nothing for a scan with no NEW/CHG/missing/risky devices - only an interesting run produces output (see --watch under cron/systemd).

Flag	What it does
--notify-webhook URL	POST a summary to URL as Slack-compatible JSON whenever a scan has something to report - same trigger as --quiet.
--diff-only	Under --watch, print only what changed since the previous tick instead of the full table every time.
--profile NAME	Load defaults from this named section in --profile-file (default: ~/.network_scanner.ini) - explicit flags still override.
--profile-file FILE	INI file --profile reads its named section from.
--metrics-file FILE	Write this scan's device/new/risky/conflict counts to FILE in Prometheus text exposition format, for node_exporter's textfile collector.
--export-known-devices FILE	Copy the known-devices registry to FILE and exit without scanning.
--import-known-devices FILE	Merge FILE's known-devices registry into the current one (imported entries win on a collision) and exit without scanning.
--mqtt-host HOST	Publish Home Assistant MQTT Discovery presence for every device found to this broker.
--mqtt-port PORT	MQTT broker port (default: 1883, or 8883 is common with --mqtt-tls).
--mqtt-username USER	MQTT broker username, if required.
--mqtt-password PASS	MQTT broker password, if required - visible in ps/shell history; prefer --mqtt-password-file or \$MQTT_PASSWORD.
--mqtt-password-file FILE	Read the MQTT broker password from FILE instead of --mqtt-password.
--mqtt-client-id ID	MQTT client ID (default: network_scanner).
--mqtt-discovery-prefix PREFIX	Home Assistant's MQTT Discovery topic prefix (default: homeassistant).
--mqtt-tls	Connect to the MQTT broker over TLS instead of plain TCP.
--mqtt-insecure-tls	Under --mqtt-tls, skip certificate hostname/chain verification (typical for a self-signed home broker).
--mqtt-no-availability	Don't publish an online/offline availability topic or set an MQTT Last Will alongside device presence.

3. mobile_network_scanner.py

For sandboxed Python runtimes — most notably iOS apps like a-Shell — that allow neither subprocess calls nor raw sockets. Every discovery technique here is built from ordinary client TCP/UDP sockets, which is the one thing every one of these sandboxes still permits.



No ARP, no IPv6 discovery, no MAC vendor lookup - ordinary sockets only.

How a scan flows through mobile_network_scanner.py, start to finish.

Running it

```
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py          # auto-detect subnet
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py 192.168.1.0/24 # scan a specific subnet
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --timeout 0.5 --ports 22,80,443
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --watch 300      # rescan every 5 minutes
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --no-banners --no-risky-ports # faster scan
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --output scan.csv # save results to a file
```

Options

Flag	What it does
subnet	Positional. CIDR range(s) to scan, comma-separated for more than one. Auto-detected if omitted.
--doctor	Skip the network scan; check this environment for everything this script can use (subnet detection, TCP connectivity, cache writability, mDNS) and report it.
--timeout SECONDS	Timeout per port probe (default: 0.5); also used for the banner-grab and risky-ports steps.

Flag	What it does
--retries N	Extra probe passes for hosts that didn't answer, to recover a device that missed one connection attempt (default: 0).
--ports LIST	Comma-separated TCP ports to probe instead of the built-in default list.
--exclude LIST	Comma-separated IPs and/or CIDR ranges to drop before probing anything (a bare IP is treated as a /32).
--mdns-timeout SECONDS	Timeout for the mDNS/Bonjour hostname fallback (default: 0.3).
--watch SECONDS	Rescan on a timer instead of once, printing NEW markers as they appear (Ctrl+C to stop).
--no-track-devices	Don't use the known-devices registry at all — no NEW/CHG markers, nothing remembered.
--forget-known-devices	Clear the registry first, so everything in this run shows as NEW.
--set-label KEY=LABEL	Assign a friendly label to a device (KEY is its IP address), shown instead of/alongside its hostname. Repeatable.
--remove-label KEY	Remove a device's custom label. Repeatable.
--no-banners	Skip banner grabbing on each device's open port — faster, but a weaker identification hint.
--no-risky-ports	Skip the risky-ports security check while keeping the general port probe.
--no-color	Disable ANSI color output (also respects the NO_COLOR env var).
--output FILE	Save this scan's results to FILE as JSON, or CSV if it ends in .csv.
--log-history FILE	Append this scan's results as one JSON line to FILE, instead of overwriting it like --output does.
--history-max-entries N	Cap FILE from --log-history at N lines, dropping the oldest first (default: 200).
--quiet	Print nothing for a scan with no NEW/CHG/missing/risky devices - only an interesting run produces output (see --watch under cron/systemd).
--notify-webhook URL	POST a summary to URL as Slack-compatible JSON whenever a scan has something to report - same trigger as --quiet.
--diff-only	Under --watch, print only what changed since the previous tick instead of the full table every time.
--profile NAME	Load defaults from this named section in --profile-file (default: ~/.mobile_network_scanner.ini) - explicit flags still override.
--profile-file FILE	INI file --profile reads its named section from.
--metrics-file FILE	Write this scan's device/new/risky counts to FILE in Prometheus text exposition format, for node_exporter's textfile collector.
--export-known-devices FILE	Copy the known-devices registry to FILE and exit without scanning.

Flag	What it does
--import-known-devices FILE	Merge FILE's known-devices registry into the current one (imported entries win on a collision) and exit without scanning.
--mqtt-host HOST	Publish Home Assistant MQTT Discovery presence for every device found to this broker.
--mqtt-port PORT	MQTT broker port (default: 1883, or 8883 is common with --mqtt-tls).
--mqtt-username USER	MQTT broker username, if required.
--mqtt-password PASS	MQTT broker password, if required - visible in ps/shell history; prefer --mqtt-password-file or \$MQTT_PASSWORD.
--mqtt-password-file FILE	Read the MQTT broker password from FILE instead of --mqtt-password.
--mqtt-client-id ID	MQTT client ID (default: mobile_network_scanner).
--mqtt-discovery-prefix PREFIX	Home Assistant's MQTT Discovery topic prefix (default: homeassistant).
--mqtt-tls	Connect to the MQTT broker over TLS instead of plain TCP.
--mqtt-insecure-tls	Under --mqtt-tls, skip certificate hostname/chain verification (typical for a self-signed home broker).
--mqtt-no-availability	Don't publish an online/offline availability topic or set an MQTT Last Will alongside device presence.

iOS limitation: mDNS/DNS-SD queries fail outright on iOS with `OSError(65, 'No route to host')` — Apple's Local Network Privacy model requires an app bundle to declare Bonjour service types in advance, which a script run from a generic terminal app can't do. Plain TCP port scanning, banner grabbing, and risky-port checks are unaffected, since they're ordinary unicast traffic.

4. Known-device tracking, color coding, and --watch

Both scripts persist a small local registry of every device they've ever seen

(`~/.cache/network_scanner_known_devices.json` and

`~/.cache/mobile_network_scanner_known_devices.json`). Every scan is compared against it, producing the markers and colors below. Pair either script with `--watch SECONDS` to turn a one-shot scan into a standing monitor.

```
python3 network_scanner.py

Scanning 192.168.1.0/24 ...

  IP Address      MAC Address      Vendor      Port  Service  Hostname
-----
NEW 192.168.1.42    3c:22:fb:1a:9c:04 Apple, Inc  62078 lockdownd iPhone.local
192.168.1.1      aa:bb:cc:dd:ee:ff Netgear    80    http    router.local
CHG 192.168.1.57    10:2c:6b:44:2a:11 Sonos      23    ?       kitchen-speaker.local
192.168.1.72     b0:c5:54:2f:88:19 Google     8009  chromecast Living Room TV
192.168.1.88     f4:5e:ab:12:34:56 Synology   445    smb     nas.local      (risky)

5 device(s) found. 1 new since last seen.
2 previously-seen device(s) not found in this scan:
192.168.1.63      last seen 2026-09-14T08:03:00 (laptop.local)
1 device(s) with a changed port since last seen:
192.168.1.57      (none) -> telnet (23)
1 device(s) exposing commonly-risky ports:
192.168.1.88     f4:5e:ab:12:34:56  smb (445)
```

Illustrative output — exact columns vary slightly between the two scripts.

Marker / color	Meaning
NEW (green)	First time this device has ever been seen.
CHG (yellow)	A known device is answering on a different port than last time.
red row	Device exposes a port on the risky-ports list (telnet, SMB, RDP, VNC, FTP).
magenta row	This IP was last attributed to a different MAC address (network_scanner.py only).
dim gray line	A previously-seen device that didn't show up in this scan.

A device can be NEW or CHG, never both — a device with no prior registry entry can't have a “changed” port, only a first one. A device can be NEW *and* a magenta IP conflict at once, though (a freshly-added device can land on an IP someone else just gave up) — row-color priority, most to least urgent: risky, conflict, new, changed port.

Resetting tracking

```
python3 network_scanner.py --no-track-devices      # skip tracking this run
python3 network_scanner.py --forget-known-devices  # reset registry, all NEW
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --watch 300      # standing monitor on phone
```

Recovering from a flaky scan (--retries)

A single dropped ARP/ping reply (or one flaky TCP connect on the mobile script) can make a live device look “missing” this run and “NEW” again next run - a false signal every registry-based feature above inherits. --retries N re-probes before finalizing results, giving a flaky device another chance to answer.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --retries 1
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --retries 2
```

The two scripts implement this differently, matching how each discovers devices: network_scanner.py's ARP/ping sweep is one broadcast across the whole subnet, so each retry re-runs that same broadcast (scapy's raw sockets aren't necessarily safe to hit concurrently from targeted single-host requests instead). mobile_network_scanner.py already probes each host individually over plain TCP, so each retry there only re-probes the specific hosts still missing a match. Both default to 0 (a single pass), preserving the original behavior exactly.

Custom device labels

The same registry can hold a friendly label for a device — useful when its real hostname is cryptic or blank — shown in place of/alongside the hostname (e.g. Kitchen Server (localhost) when they differ). KEY is a device's MAC (or IP if it has none) for network_scanner.py, or always its IP for mobile_network_scanner.py.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --set-label aa:bb:cc:dd:ee:ff="Kitchen Server"
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --set-label 192.168.1.42="Kitchen Echo"
python3 network_scanner.py --remove-label aa:bb:cc:dd:ee:ff
```

Both flags are repeatable and take effect immediately, including on the scan that runs in the same command. A device doesn't need to already be in the registry — labeling one creates a minimal entry for it, though that also means it won't show as NEW the next time it's actually scanned.

IP-conflict / spoofing alerts (network_scanner.py only)

The same registry also catches a device's IP being taken over by a different MAC address than last time — a DHCP lease getting handed to a new device is the ordinary cause, but it's exactly the same signal something spoofing another device's IP (most notably ARP-poisoning your router's own address) would produce. A conflicting device prints in magenta and shows up in its own summary section.

This is a hygiene signal, not an intrusion-detection system — most hits will be completely benign lease reassignments. A conflict on your router/gateway's own IP is the one case worth treating as urgent rather than routine. Only compares devices that both have a real MAC address, so a ping-sweep-only device (no MAC at all) can't trigger or be flagged by this. Not available on mobile_network_scanner.py, which has no MAC address to compare in the first place. Skipped entirely with - -no-track-devices.

5. Exporting results

Both scripts can save a scan's results to a file with `--output FILE`, independent of the known-devices registry above — useful for feeding results into another tool, diffing two scans, or just keeping a dated record. The format is chosen by the file extension: `.csv` writes a CSV file, anything else (typically `.json`) writes JSON.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --output scan.json
python3 network_scanner.py --output scan.csv
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --output scan.json
```

Each run overwrites FILE with that scan's results — this is a snapshot of the latest scan, not an appended history log.

6. Diffing two scans

scan_diff.py is a third, standalone script that compares two files saved with --output above and reports what changed: devices added, devices that disappeared, and per-field changes (a different port, hostname, banner, etc.) on devices present in both — the same NEW/missing/CHG comparison the scanners do against their own known-devices registry, just applied to two snapshots on disk instead.

```
python3 scan_diff.py old.json new.json
python3 scan_diff.py before.csv after.csv
python3 scan_diff.py --no-color old.json new.json
```

Either file can be JSON or CSV independently (comparing a CSV export against a JSON one works fine), and they don't need to come from the same script: fields the two scanners don't share (mac/vendor are desktop-only, banner is mobile-only) are still compared whenever both files happen to have them. A device is matched across the two files by MAC when present, falling back to IP — the same identity rule network_scanner.py's own known-devices tracking uses.

7. Quiet mode and environment diagnostics

--quiet

Suppresses everything — even the scan's own “Scanning...” line — for a run with nothing to report: no NEW devices, no port changes, no missing devices, and no risky ports. As soon as one of those is true, the full report prints exactly as it would without --quiet. Meant for --watch under cron/systemd, where a boring rescan producing zero output (rather than a full table every time) is what makes “did anything happen” easy to grep for or alert on.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --watch 300 --quiet
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --watch 300 --quiet
```

--doctor

Skips the network scan and instead checks this environment for everything the script can use — scapy, ping/arp, cache-directory writability, mDNS multicast, and so on — reporting each with a clear pass/fail and, for most, the fallback that kicks in when it fails. Exits 0 if every check passed, 1 otherwise, so it's usable as a pre-flight check in a script.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --doctor
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --doctor
```

A failed check doesn't necessarily mean a scan will fail — most have a documented fallback (no arp on PATH just means no MAC from that path, not a crash). The one exception: a failed mDNS check on `mobile_network_scanner.py` almost always means iOS's Local Network Privacy restriction (see `mdns_diagnostic.py`), which no retry or code change here can fix.

8. Notifications for --watch

--notify-webhook URL POSTs a plain-text summary to URL as {"text": "..."} JSON — the format Slack's incoming webhooks (and many other generic webhook receivers) expect directly — whenever a scan has a NEW device, a port change, a missing device, or a risky port to report. A boring scan sends nothing at all, the same trigger condition --quiet uses, so the two pair naturally under --watch.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --watch 300 \  
  --notify-webhook https://hooks.slack.com/services/...  
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --watch 300 \  
  --notify-webhook https://ntfy.sh/your-topic
```

A failed or unreachable webhook prints a warning to stderr and the scan continues normally — it never crashes the run. This deliberately doesn't special-case any one service's exact payload shape; a target expecting something else (Discord's content key, ntfy.sh's plain-text body) may need a small relay in between, or just point it at a service that already speaks the Slack-compatible format.

9. Excluding devices from a scan

--exclude IP/CIDR skips one or more addresses — comma-separated, each either a bare IP (treated as a /32) or a CIDR range — from the rest of a scan, without narrowing the whole subnet just to dodge one host: a printer that crashes under port probes, a NAS you don't want woken from sleep, or a noisy neighbor you just don't care about.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --exclude 192.168.1.5
python3 network_scanner.py --exclude 192.168.1.5,192.168.1.10
python3 network_scanner.py --exclude 192.168.1.0/28
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --exclude 192.168.1.5,10.0.0.0/24
```

On `mobile_network_scanner.py`, exclusion is complete: excluded hosts are dropped from the list before any TCP connection is ever attempted, so nothing at all reaches them. On `network_scanner.py`'s ARP path, the initial ARP broadcast still reaches every host on the subnet — `scapy`'s `srp()` sends one request across the whole range in a single call, with no way to carve individual addresses out of that broadcast — but excluded devices are dropped immediately after discovery, before vendor lookup, port scanning, the risky-ports check, and the final report/export/tracking, so in practice they're never touched beyond that one broadcast packet. The ping-sweep fallback still pings every host itself and filters after, since it has no equivalent single-broadcast step to route around.

10. Scan history log

`--log-history FILE` appends every scan's results to `FILE` as one JSON line per run (`{"timestamp": "...", "devices": [...]}`), instead of overwriting it like `--output` does — useful under `--watch` for keeping a record of what the network looked like over time, or for feeding into your own analysis later (each line parses independently, so you don't need to load the whole file to read one entry).

```
python3 network_scanner.py --watch 300 --log-history history.jsonl
python3 mobile_network_scanner.py --log-history history.jsonl
```

The file is capped at 200 entries by default (oldest dropped first) so it doesn't grow forever under a long-running `--watch`; override with `--history-max-entries N`.

```
python3 network_scanner.py --watch 300 --log-history history.jsonl \
--history-max-entries 1000
```

11. Shell tab-completion

completions.bash adds bash tab-completion for each script's flag names (30+ per script by now, easy to half-remember). Source it from your ~/.bashrc:

```
source /path/to/local-network-toolkit/completions.bash
```

It only completes flag *names*, not their arguments (a subnet, a port list, a file path), and only fires for a direct invocation matching a script's own name (./network_scanner.py, or the bare name if it's on PATH — the scripts in this repo already have their executable bit set). python3

network_scanner.py <TAB> does **not** trigger it: bash keys completion off the first word of the command line, which is python3 in that case, not the script — putting the script on PATH so the bare-name form works is the practical fix.

12. mdns_browser.py: browsing mDNS/DNS-SD

The other two scripts only ever ask mDNS/DNS-SD one narrow question at a time - what's this IP's hostname, or is anything answering as a Chromecast. `mdns_browser.py` asks the broader one: what services exist on this network at all - printers, AirPlay speakers, SSH-capable hosts, HomeKit accessories, anything advertising itself - without needing to already know an IP or guess a service type first.

```
python3 mdns_browser.py                # discover + browse everything
python3 mdns_browser.py --timeout 3
python3 mdns_browser.py --services _http._tcp.local,_ipp._tcp.local
python3 mdns_browser.py --no-discover   # built-ins only, skip discovery
python3 mdns_browser.py --output services.json
```

Works in two phases. First, DNS-SD's own “meta-query” (`_services._dns-sd._udp.local`, RFC 6763 §9) asks which service types are actually in use - not every device implements this even when it implements browsing for its own type, so the result is unioned with a small built-in list of common types (Chromecast, AirPlay, IPP printers, SMB, SSH, HomeKit, and more). Second, it browses all of those types at once on a single socket, joining each response's PTR/SRV/A records into an `{ip: name}` map per type - the same `join_mobile_network_scanner.py`'s own `mdns_service_lookup()` does for Chromecast specifically, generalized here to many types in one pass.

Best-effort, like the mDNS code elsewhere in this project (one query per type, reading whatever comes back within `--timeout`), and shares the same iOS Local Network Privacy limitation as the other two scripts' mDNS lookups.

13. Scanning nearby Wi-Fi networks (wifi_scanner.py)

A different, complementary question from the rest of this project: not “what devices are on my network” but “what networks are in radio range at all,” including ones you’re not connected to. A network that feels slow is often channel congestion from a neighbor on the same channel, or a weak signal - neither of which device discovery can see.

```
python3 wifi_scanner.py
python3 wifi_scanner.py --timeout 15
python3 wifi_scanner.py --output networks.json
```

Shells out to each OS’s own Wi-Fi tooling: nmcli on Linux, the airport command-line tool on macOS (still present despite Apple’s deprecation notice), and netsh wlan show networks on Windows. Signal strength stays in whatever unit each platform’s own tool reports (a percentage on Linux/Windows, dBm on macOS) rather than being converted between them - there is no one true conversion, so labeling each honestly beats a false unification. An open/unencrypted network is called out in the output, the same hygiene-flagging spirit as RISKY_PORTS elsewhere in this project.

Known limitation, stated plainly: this project’s own development environment has none of nmcli, airport, or netsh installed and no Wi-Fi hardware at all, so every platform’s parser here is verified only against mocked command output matching each tool’s documented format, never against a real device on real hardware, on any of the three platforms. Treat a first real run on any platform as the verification it hasn’t had yet.

14. exposure_check.py: internet-facing exposure

RISKY_PORTS elsewhere in this project flags a port from inside the LAN - but a risky port reachable only from your own network is a much smaller problem than the same port reachable from the whole internet. This asks the sharper question: is a LAN-risky port (or any port you name) also reachable from outside, by probing your own public IP from this machine.

```
python3 exposure_check.py                # RISKY_PORTS, auto-detected IP
python3 exposure_check.py --ports 22,80,443,8080
python3 exposure_check.py --ip 203.0.113.5 --ports 22
python3 exposure_check.py --output exposure.json
```

Your public IP is found with a single plain HTTP(S) request to api.ipify.org - a small, purpose-built “what’s my IP” echo service, no account or API key needed, returning just the address as plain text. No other data about your network is sent anywhere; --ip skips this request entirely if you’d rather not make it, or already know the address.

Read this before trusting a result: probing your own public IP from inside your own LAN is not a reliable substitute for a real external scan. Home routers implement NAT loopback/hairpinning inconsistently - some silently drop this traffic (a genuinely open port reports as a false “closed” here), others loop it back to a LAN device without truly routing it to the internet and back (a false “open” that doesn’t prove an actual outside host could reach it). A closed result here is never proof of safety, and an open result is never definitive proof of exposure - both need confirming from a real external vantage point (a VPS, a friend’s network, a phone on cellular data with Wi-Fi off, or a third-party online port-checking site you choose yourself) before acting on either one. This tool is a cheap first pass, not the final word - the CLI itself prints this same caveat after every run.

15. traceroute_mapper.py: path mapping

Neither exposure_check.py's "is this port reachable" nor wifi_scanner.py's "is my signal weak" says where along the path a slow connection is actually slow. This does, by wrapping the OS's own traceroute tool and reporting every hop's IP, hostname, and round-trip time.

```
python3 traceroute_mapper.py 8.8.8.8
python3 traceroute_mapper.py google.com --max-hops 20
python3 traceroute_mapper.py 192.168.1.1 --no-resolve-hostnames
python3 traceroute_mapper.py 8.8.8.8 --output path.json
```

Runs each platform's tool numeric-only (traceroute -n on Linux/macOS, tracert -d on Windows) specifically to sidestep the biggest source of cross-platform output differences, then resolves each hop's hostname itself afterward via plain reverse DNS rather than depending on the traceroute binary's own often-inconsistent DNS handling. A hop that timed out on every probe still shows up (no IP, three missed replies) rather than being silently dropped, so a gap in the path stays visible.

Known limitation, stated plainly: this project's own development environment has no traceroute/tracert binary installed at all, so every platform's parser here is verified only against mocked command output matching each tool's documented format, never against a real path on real hardware, on any of the three platforms. Traceroute output varies more between tool versions/distros than most formats parsed elsewhere in this project - treat a first real run on any platform as the verification it hasn't had yet.

16. arp_monitor.py: ARP-spoofing watch

network_scanner.py's IP-conflict alert only samples at scan time - a full scan every few minutes at best under --watch - so a live man-in-the-middle attack happening between scans can go unnoticed until the next one, if ever. arp_monitor.py watches continuously instead: every ARP reply on the wire is observed as it happens, and any IP whose MAC changes mid-session is flagged immediately.

```
python3 arp_monitor.py                # watch default interface
python3 arp_monitor.py --interface eth0
python3 arp_monitor.py --log conflicts.jsonl
```

Needs scapy and the same raw-socket privileges (root/administrator) as network_scanner.py's ARP scan - there's no way to passively observe ARP traffic without them. Like the IP-conflict alert it complements, this is a hygiene/detection aid, not a full intrusion-detection system: a MAC change is exactly as likely to be an ordinary DHCP lease reassignment as an actual attack. A change on your router/gateway's own IP is the one case worth treating as urgent.

Known limitation, stated plainly: this project's own development environment has a broken scapy/cryptography install (see --doctor in network_scanner.py) and no raw-socket privileges either, so the actual packet-sniffing path has never run for real here. The pure detection logic it calls (process_arp_observation()) is fully unit-tested and needs nothing from scapy at all; the sniff() wiring around it is verified only by faking out the scapy import in tests, not against real ARP traffic on real hardware.

17. lan_throughput.py: LAN throughput

None of the other tools here measure this at all: “my internet feels slow” and “my LAN itself is slow” are different problems, and only a real transfer between two devices on the same network tells you which one you actually have.

```
python3 lan_throughput.py --serve
python3 lan_throughput.py --serve --port 6000 --once
python3 lan_throughput.py --client 192.168.1.50
python3 lan_throughput.py --client 192.168.1.50 --duration 10
```

Plain TCP sockets, no dependency: one machine listens and reports what it received; the other streams random data at it for a fixed duration (random, not zeros, since some links compress a repeating pattern in a way that would over-report the result) and reports what it actually managed to send. This measures TCP goodput between exactly these two processes, not raw link-layer bandwidth or a multi-stream aggregate the way a dedicated tool like iperf3 does - treat it as a quick, no-install sanity check, not a substitute for iperf3 when a rigorous number is needed.

18. upnp_audit.py: UPnP port audit

exposure_check.py answers "is this port reachable from outside" after the fact, by probing your public IP. This answers a sharper, earlier question: why a port might be open at all, even though nothing in a LAN scan looks unusual. Many home routers ship with UPnP enabled, letting any device on the network ask the router to forward a port from the internet straight to itself - a game console, a BitTorrent client, a smart-home hub - with no further confirmation and no trace visible from LAN-side scanning at all. This queries the router itself for its current UPnP port-mapping table.

```
python3 upnp_audit.py
python3 upnp_audit.py --timeout 5
python3 upnp_audit.py --output mappings.json
```

Works in three steps: SSDP multicast discovery finds the router's UPnP Internet Gateway Device (the same request/response shape mDNS/DNS-SD's own discovery is built on, an older HTTP-header-flavored sibling protocol); its XML device description is fetched and walked - regardless of nesting depth, since routers vary here - to find the WANIPConnection or WANPPPPConnection service that actually manages port forwarding; then that service's GetGenericPortMappingEntry SOAP action is called once per index until the router reports there are no more. A mapping forwarding a port already on RISKY_PORTS is called out specifically.

Known limitation, stated plainly: this project's own development environment has no reachable UPnP Internet Gateway Device. The full SSDP -> XML -> SOAP pipeline is verified against a real, unmocked gateway simulated locally - a genuine SSDP responder plus a genuine HTTP server serving real XML/SOAP bodies, all over real sockets - which exercises every wire-format detail this script depends on, but it has never spoken to an actual router. Router UPnP stacks are inconsistent about spec compliance in ways a simulated one won't reproduce; treat a first real run as the verification it hasn't had yet.